

Rhetorical technique - Workbook 1

Focused practice - Workbook 1 of 3

How to use this workbook

Read each text closely. Decide what relationship the question is testing before looking at the options. After checking the key, explain why the strongest wrong answer fails.

Before you start

- Use the surrounding text, not one isolated keyword.
- Prefer precise relationship words such as illustrates, qualifies, contrasts, supports, or results in.
- Do not accept an answer that merely summarizes when the question asks about function or effect.

Night Bus

"One missed bus can mean one missed shift. One missed shift can mean one smaller paycheck," the letter states before asking the transit agency to extend evening service.

1. Which rhetorical technique is most important in this example?

- A. repetition
- B. a definition used only to introduce vocabulary
- C. a chronological list of unrelated events
- D. a neutral transition with no rhetorical effect

2. What does the technique accomplish in this text?

- A. It proves a broader claim that the example cannot establish.
- B. Repeating "one missed" emphasizes a chain of consequences from a single transportation problem.
- C. It changes the topic instead of developing the writer's point.
- D. It adds decoration without affecting emphasis, clarity, or persuasion.

Leaky Roof

A fundraising letter begins with a story about volunteers moving buckets around children during a community-center class while rain came through the ceiling.

3. Which rhetorical technique is most important in this example?

- A. a definition used only to introduce vocabulary
- B. a chronological list of unrelated events
- C. anecdote
- D. a neutral transition with no rhetorical effect

4. What does the technique accomplish in this text?

- A. It proves a broader claim that the example cannot establish.
- B. It changes the topic instead of developing the writer's point.
- C. It adds decoration without affecting emphasis, clarity, or persuasion.
- D. The story makes the roof problem concrete by showing how it disrupts an ordinary activity.

Library Cards

The library report notes that 64 percent of new card registrations last year were completed online. It uses the figure while recommending that the online form remain available.

5. Which rhetorical technique is most important in this example?

- A. statistic
- B. a definition used only to introduce vocabulary
- C. a chronological list of unrelated events
- D. a neutral transition with no rhetorical effect

6. What does the technique accomplish in this text?

- A. It proves a broader claim that the example cannot establish.
- B. The number establishes that online registration is used by a substantial share of new members.
- C. It changes the topic instead of developing the writer's point.
- D. It adds decoration without affecting emphasis, clarity, or persuasion.

Answer key and reasoning

1. A. The writer uses repetition.
2. B. Repeating "one missed" emphasizes a chain of consequences from a single transportation problem.
3. C. The writer uses anecdote.
4. D. The story makes the roof problem concrete by showing how it disrupts an ordinary activity.
5. A. The writer uses statistic.
6. B. The number establishes that online registration is used by a substantial share of new members.

Mistake review

- If you summarized instead of explaining a relationship, label it summary-not-function.
- If you chose a transition or structure because of one keyword, label it one-clue trap.
- If you confused a quoted perspective with the author's own view, label it viewpoint source.
- If you named a rhetorical device but missed what it achieves, label it effect missed.
- Redo missed questions later without looking at the key.